Yes, you can set up an internal supplementary DNS that complements your split-tunnel WireGuard VPN. This allows your devices to resolve custom internal domain names (e.g., vm1.internal) to the private IPs of your GCP VMs without exposing them publicly, while keeping general internet DNS resolution efficient. Since your setup is split-tunnel (only VPC traffic routes through the VPN), we'll run a lightweight DNS resolver on the VPN server VM to handle internal queries locally and forward external ones to a public resolver like 8.8.8.8. All DNS traffic from your devices will go through the VPN (to prevent leaks), but external data traffic remains direct.

This isn't "true" domain-based split DNS (where only internal domains query the VPN DNS, and others use your device's default)—that's more complex and OS-specific (e.g., requires local resolvers on each device). For a simple hobbyist setup, the approach below works cross-platform with minimal changes. If you need true split DNS, I can outline device-specific tweaks at the end.

Step 1: Set Up DNS on the VPN Server VM

We'll use `unbound` (open-source, secure, and easy) as the DNS resolver. It runs on your Ubuntu VM, resolves internal names using GCP's metadata DNS (which auto-resolves VM instance names), and forwards the rest.

1. SSH into the VPN server VM.
2. Install unbound: `sudo apt update && sudo apt install unbound -y`.
3. Configure unbound in `/etc/unbound/unbound.conf` (replace with this minimal config):

```text
server:
    interface: 10.0.0.1  # Listen on VPN IP
    access-control: 10.0.0.0/24 allow  # Only allow from VPN clients
    domain-insecure: "c.<project-id>.internal"  # Your GCP internal zone
    local-zone: "internal." static  # Optional: Custom zone for your nam

    # Example custom records (add for each VM; use their private IPs)
    local-data: "vm1.internal. IN A <vm1-private-ip>"
    local-data: "vm2.internal. IN A <vm2-private-ip>"

forward-zone:
    name: "c.<project-id>.internal"
    forward-addr: 169.254.169.254  # GCP metadata DNS for auto-resolving

forward-zone:
    name: "."
    forward-addr: 8.8.8.8  # Forward external queries
    forward-addr: 8.8.4.4
```

   - Customize: If you don't want GCP auto-names, remove the GCP-specific forward-zone and add more local-data entries.
   - For security, unbound validates DNSSEC by default.
4. Restart unbound: `sudo systemctl restart unbound`.
5. Test locally on server: `dig @127.0.0.1 vm1.internal` (should return the IP). Test external: `dig @127.0.0.1 google.com`.

Step 2: Update WireGuard Client Configs

For each device's `.conf` file (from previous setup):

- Add to the [Interface] section: `DNS = 10.0.0.1` (the server's VPN IP).
- Re-import the updated config into the WireGuard app on your Mac, iPhone, and Android tablet.

When connected:

- Your devices will send all DNS queries to 10.0.0.1 via the tunnel.
- Internal names (e.g., ping vm1.internal) resolve to private IPs and route through the VPN (due to AllowedIPs).
- External names resolve normally, but data traffic bypasses the VPN.

This is "split tunnel style" because DNS is supplementary (handles internal without overriding everything), and only adds minimal overhead. Test by connecting and resolving an internal name—traffic stays internal.

Tips and Security

- GCP instance names: If using them, ensure VMs have unique names in the console; unbound will resolve them via 169.254.169.254.
- Firewall: GCP already allows internal UDP/53, but add a rule for UDP 53 from VPC subnet to the server if needed.
- No data routing change: VMs' outbound internet remains direct.
- If you prefer dnsmasq over unbound: Similar setup, but unbound is more modern.
- Costs: Negligible for hobby use.

If this routes too much DNS through the VPN for your taste (e.g., privacy concerns), true domain-split DNS is possible but requires per-device config:

- **Mac**: Install dnsmasq locally, configure it to forward only *.internal to 10.0.0.1, and set WireGuard DNS=127.0.0.1. See the method in this thread.
- **iOS**: Official WireGuard app doesn't support domain splits natively. Use the Passepartout app (free/open-source) which allows custom DNS policies per domain.
- **Android**: Official app supports app-based splits but not domain-DNS. Use Rethink DNS app alongside WireGuard for domain-based forwarding.

Let me know if you want steps for the advanced version or tweaks!